WORKING WITH LARGE DATA SETS

Working with large data sets in Excel can be difficult, especially for those new to Excel. In these pages we have summarized some useful tips for managing and analysing data more effectively.

- **Using filters**
  Excel filters can help you quickly narrow data to show only the information you need. To apply filters to data, select the data range you want to filter and click the *Filter* button on the *Data* tab. You can then select the criteria to filter using the drop-down arrows that appear in the column headings.

- **Using PivotTables**
  PivotTables are an effective tool that can help you analyse and summarize large data sets. To create a PivotTable, select the data range you want to analyse and click the "*PivotTable*" button on the "*Insert*" tab. You can then drag and drop fields into the "*Rows*", "*Columns*", and "Values" areas to create a summary table.

- **Using conditional formatting**
  Conditional formatting allows you to apply different formatting options to cells based on their values. To apply conditional formatting, select the range of cells you want to format and click the "*Conditional Formatting*" button on the "*Home''* tab.
  With this type of formatting, you can choose which criteria to use, such as underlining cells that include a certain value.

- **Using keyboard shortcuts**
  As anticipated, using keyboard shortcuts allows you to work more quickly and efficiently. Memorizing the most common shortcuts can save time and reduce errors. Some useful shortcuts for working with large data sets are *Ctrl+Shift+End* to select all cells in a data set, *Ctrl+Shift+L* to turn filtering on and off, and *Ctrl+T* to create a table.

- **Use named ranges**
  Named ranges allow you to refer to a specific range of cells with